discarded grass stems lying on the ground. Picking one up and poking it into the mound, she found that the agitated termites bit onto the stem. She realized that the chimp had been “fishing” for termites with the grass stems, and transferring them into his mouth.

From talks with Leakey, Goodall knew this was a major discovery. She also saw chimps modifying thin twigs by stripping them of leaves and then using them in termite mounds; the chimps were not only using tools but making them.



A chimp uses a twig stripped of its leaves—a modified “tool”—to catch termites for consumption. Goodall first recorded the ability of chimpanzees to invent simple technologies in Gombe.